

Anticoagulant Quick Reference — Apixaban (Eliquis)

Apixaban is a direct oral anticoagulant (a factor Xa inhibitor) used to reduce the risk of stroke in nonvalvular atrial fibrillation and to treat and prevent venous thromboembolism. The standard dose for atrial fibrillation is 5 mg taken orally twice daily. Apixaban does not require routine INR monitoring, which distinguishes it from warfarin.

Apixaban — Dose Reduction Criteria

Reduce the apixaban dose to 2.5 mg twice daily in atrial fibrillation when the patient meets at least two of the following three criteria: age 80 years or older; body weight 60 kg or less; serum creatinine 1.5 mg/dL or higher. For treatment of venous thromboembolism, the reduction criteria differ and dose changes follow the initial treatment period. Always confirm renal function before and during therapy, because reduced kidney clearance increases drug exposure.

Warfarin and Rivaroxaban — Contrast

Warfarin is a vitamin K antagonist that requires regular INR monitoring, with a typical target INR of 2 to 3. Its effect is reversible with vitamin K. Rivaroxaban is another factor Xa inhibitor; the atrial fibrillation dose is 20 mg once daily taken with the evening meal, reduced to 15 mg once daily for impaired renal function. Unlike apixaban, rivaroxaban is dosed once daily and absorption depends on food for the higher doses.